“Getting close to people will cost me my freedom.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you find yourself pulling away when someone tries to get close? Do you worry that letting people in will mean losing your independence or being controlled? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing that closeness with safe people does not have to cost you your freedom, and to find the peace that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A person who grew up with controlling, intrusive, or unpredictable caregivers may learn that being close means being managed, criticized, or swallowed up. Others learned that needs were a burden and that self-reliance was the safe way to live. Distance then feels like freedom, even when it has quietly become the walls of a small life.

How the belief can keep itself going

Keeping people at arm’s length does protect us from being controlled, so it seems to work. But the same distance blocks the experience of being close to someone who respects us, so the belief never gets tested. We also tend to picture closeness at its worst. Gathering evidence from safe, healthy relationships can start to loosen it.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not describe freedom as the absence of people. Christ sets us free, and that freedom is meant to be lived out in love for others. God places the lonely in families. Real love does not seize control; it serves. These passages teach that closeness and freedom were never meant to be enemies.

> *“For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love.” (Galatians 5:13)*

Also see

> “It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not be encumbered once more by a yoke of slavery.” (Galatians 5:1)

> “So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed.” (John 8:36)

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land.” (Psalm 68:6)

> “As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.” (Proverbs 27:17)

Common self-statements

- If I let someone in, they will take over my life.
- I need my space, and people always want more of me.
- Being close means giving up who I am.
- I stay free by not getting involved.
- Commitments are cages.
- It is easier to keep everyone at a distance.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either completely free and alone or completely controlled and close.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anyone close to me will take over.
- Overgeneralizing: Assuming everyone will treat me the way a controlling person once did.
- Emotional reasoning: Taking the feeling of being crowded as proof that I am in danger.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing times when someone was close and still respected my space.
- Mislabeling: Calling every kind of closeness "control."

Challenging questions

- Who, in my past, made closeness feel like a loss of freedom, and is everyone like that person?
- Can I think of a person who respected my space and my choices?
- What has staying distant cost me, and what has it protected?
- Can closeness have boundaries, so that I can say yes or no and still be close?
- What does Scripture say real freedom is for?
- Could a small, chosen amount of closeness feel different from being controlled?
- What is one safe person with whom I could practice saying what I need?

Truth summary

Closeness and freedom are not opposites. Healthy relationships have room for boundaries, differences, and choices. I can say no and still be loved. Christ gives me true freedom, and He invites me to use it to love and be loved. I can choose how close to get, one safe step at a time.

A short prayer

Lord, You know why I guard my freedom so tightly. Heal the places where closeness once hurt. Show me safe people, teach me healthy boundaries, and help me use the freedom You gave me to love and be loved. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Communication
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Rest in being welcomed as you are, with no pressure to perform.

Known
Tauren Wells

Reflect on being fully known and still loved.

No Longer Slaves
Jonathan David & Melissa Helser

Remember that in Christ you are no longer a slave to fear.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Practice trusting God as you let others closer, step by step.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Detachment is sometimes a learned response to intrusive or controlling relationships; distinguishing a person's real boundary needs from fear-based avoidance helps set the pace. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What is one small, safe connection I can choose today, on my own terms?"

My Plan for Replacing "Getting close to people will cost me my freedom."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Getting close to people will cost me my freedom." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when closeness starts to feel like a loss of freedom.

- ☐ Who, in my past, made closeness feel like a loss of freedom, and is everyone like that person?
- ☐ Can I think of a person who respected my space and my choices?
- ☐ What has staying distant cost me, and what has it protected?
- ☐ Can closeness have boundaries, so that I can say yes or no and still be close?
- ☐ What does Scripture say real freedom is for?
- ☐ Could a small, chosen amount of closeness feel different from being controlled?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Closeness and freedom can live together.
- ☐ I can set boundaries and still be close.
- ☐ I can say no and still be loved.
- ☐ Not every person will control me the way someone once did.
- ☐ Christ gives me freedom to love and be loved.
- ☐ I choose how close to get, one step at a time.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Galatians 5:13
  "For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love."
- ☐ Galatians 5:1
  "It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not be encumbered once more by a yoke of slavery."
- ☐ John 8:36
  "So if the Son sets you free, you will be free indeed."
- ☐ Psalm 68:6

“God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land.”

☐ Proverbs 27:17
“As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Loneliness. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Choose one safe person and spend a short, planned time together, such as a coffee or a walk. Decide in advance how long you will stay.
- ☐ Practice one respectful “no” or “not right now” with someone safe, and notice whether the relationship survives.
- ☐ Tell a trusted person one small thing you need, such as quiet time after a gathering.
- ☐ List three ways a close relationship could add to your freedom, such as help, company, and encouragement.
- ☐ Notice one moment this week when someone respected your space, and write down what happened.
- ☐ Write a prayer about what you fear losing, and read Galatians 5:13 aloud.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about freedom, closeness, and being welcomed by God.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Getting close to people will cost me my freedom.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Closeness and freedom can go together. I can set boundaries, say no, and still be loved.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Galatians 5:13

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for the freedom You gave me. Help me to use it to love, to set healthy boundaries, and to let safe people in. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

“I don’t need anyone. I am better off alone.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you feel that you are better off on your own and that you don’t really need anyone? Have you learned to rely only on yourself? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward seeing that God made us for relationship, and to find the comfort that comes from knowing His word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

A child whose needs went unmet, or who learned that people were unreliable, can decide to need no one. Being self-sufficient then becomes a source of pride and safety. Some people also find quiet and solitude genuinely restful, and the belief grows from a real preference stretched into a rule about everyone.

How the belief can keep itself going

Needing no one can feel strong, and it protects from disappointment. But it also means the person never receives what only others can give, such as comfort, correction, laughter, and help. Without those experiences, there is nothing to challenge the belief, and solitude can slowly become isolation.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says plainly that it is not good for us to be alone. God designed us for one another, like parts of one body, and no part can truthfully say to another, “I do not need you.” Quiet time with God is good and Jesus often withdrew to pray, but He did not live cut off from people. These passages teach that need is part of how we were made, not a weakness.

> *“The LORD God also said, ‘It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.’” (Genesis 2:18)*

Also see

> “The eye cannot say to the hand, ‘I do not need you.’ Nor can the head say to the feet, ‘I do not need you.’” (1 Corinthians 12:21)

> “So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another.” (Romans 12:5)

> “He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment.” (Proverbs 18:1)

> “A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.” (Proverbs 17:17)

Common self-statements

- I do not need anyone.
- I am happier on my own.
- People just complicate things.
- I have always been a loner, and that is fine.
- I can handle everything myself.
- Other people are not worth the trouble.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning “I enjoy quiet” into “nobody is necessary.”
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing life as either independent or dependent, with nothing in between.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring times when someone’s help, company, or kindness made things better.
- Mislabeling: Calling a fear of being hurt “independence.”
- Selective attention: Counting the problems people cause and overlooking what they give.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling calm when alone and concluding that it is all I need.

Challenging questions

- What is the difference between enjoying solitude and believing I need no one?
- When was the last time I truly needed help, and what happened?
- What did I learn early in life about whether people could be counted on?
- What might I be missing by never letting anyone in?
- What does God say about the way He made us?
- Is it possible that being “better off alone” is a belief I learned, not a fact?
- If a friend told me they needed no one, what would I want them to know?

Truth summary

Enjoying quiet time is healthy, but needing no one is not how God made me. He created us for one another, and receiving help, comfort, and friendship is part of being human. I can value solitude and still choose connection. Needing others is not weakness; it is design.

A short prayer

Lord, You made me for connection, even when I have learned to live without it. Soften the places where I decided to need no one. Bring safe people into my life, and help me to receive what You want to give through them. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Church
- Help

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Known
Tauren Wells

Reflect on the comfort of being fully known and loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Let yourself be welcomed, even in your need.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember that God's goodness often reaches us through people.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Rest in who God says you are, a person made for love.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. A preference for solitude is not itself a problem; the concern is a rigid conviction that closeness has no value, especially when it narrows life or costs the person support. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Who could I reach out to, or receive from, today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I don't need anyone. I am better off alone."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "I don't need anyone. I am better off alone." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you catch yourself thinking, "I don't need anyone."

- ☐ What is the difference between enjoying solitude and believing I need no one?
- ☐ When was the last time I truly needed help, and what happened?
- ☐ What did I learn early in life about whether people could be counted on?
- ☐ What might I be missing by never letting anyone in?
- ☐ What does God say about the way He made us?
- ☐ Is it possible that being "better off alone" is a belief I learned, not a fact?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Enjoying solitude is good, but I was made for connection.
- ☐ Needing others is not weakness; it is how God designed me.
- ☐ I can value quiet and still choose people.
- ☐ Help and company can add to my life.
- ☐ I do not have to do everything alone.
- ☐ God places people in my life as a gift.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Genesis 2:18
  "The LORD God also said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make for him a suitable helper.'"
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:21
  "The eye cannot say to the hand, 'I do not need you.' Nor can the head say to the feet, 'I do not need you.'"
- ☐ Romans 12:5
  "So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another."
- ☐ Proverbs 18:1
  "He who isolates himself pursues selfish desires; he rebels against all sound judgment."

☐ Proverbs 17:17
“A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.”

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Loneliness. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ List three times someone helped you, and note how it felt.
- ☐ Ask one safe person for a small favor or piece of advice, and record what happened.
- ☐ Accept an invitation you would usually decline, and stay for a set short time.
- ☐ Send a short message to someone you have not spoken to in a while.
- ☐ Spend a few minutes noticing what you enjoy about being with a particular person.
- ☐ Write a prayer asking God to show you who He has placed in your life.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about being known, welcomed, and made for connection.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~I don't need anyone. I am better off alone.~~

NEW TRUTH:
I was made for connection. Needing others is not weakness; it is how God designed me.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Genesis 2:18

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for making me for relationship. Help me to value quiet without shutting people out, and to receive the help and friendship You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #13 · CLOSENESS AND CONNECTION · DEPENDING CAUSES TROUBLE

“Depending on anyone only leads to trouble.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you hesitate to count on anyone because you expect to be let down? Do you feel that depending on others only leads to trouble? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward trusting dependable people again, and to find the security that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When people who should have been dependable were absent, unpredictable, or let us down, we learn that depending on others ends in disappointment. A child who had to take care of herself or himself too early can decide that needing anyone is dangerous. Self-reliance then feels like wisdom.

How the belief can keep itself going

If we never depend on anyone, no one has the chance to prove reliable. Every close call is remembered, and every kept promise goes unnoticed. We also take on everything alone, which can lead to exhaustion and loneliness, and that seems to confirm that people are not worth the trouble.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture teaches that two are better than one, and that a companion can lift us up when we fall. Our first dependence is on God, who is faithful when people are not, and He often helps us through the people He sends. We are also told to carry one another’s burdens. These passages do not say every person is reliable, but they show that wise, careful dependence is part of God’s design.

> *“Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10)*

Also see

> “And though one may be overpowered, two can resist. Moreover, a cord of three strands is not quickly broken.” (Ecclesiastes 4:12)

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother.” (Proverbs 18:24)

> “Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge.” (Psalm 62:8)

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- If I rely on someone, they will let me down.
- It is safer to do everything myself.
- Needing people just creates problems.
- I do not ask for help.
- People are only reliable until they are not.

- I would rather struggle alone than owe anyone.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Concluding that everyone is undependable because some people were.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must depend on nobody or depend on everybody.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anyone I rely on will fail me.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking times when someone came through.
- Catastrophizing: Treating any disappointment as a disaster.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling uneasy about needing someone and concluding it is unsafe.

Challenging questions

- Who failed me in the past, and are all people like them?
- Can I recall someone who was dependable?
- What does doing everything alone cost me?
- Could I depend on a person a little, in a small, low-risk way?
- Is there a difference between wise and foolish dependence?
- How has God been faithful when people were not?
- What would I tell a friend who was exhausted from carrying everything alone?

Truth summary

Some people have let me down, but not everyone will. I can depend on others carefully, a little at a time, and learn who is trustworthy. I can depend on God completely. Relying on others is not foolish when I choose wisely, and it can lighten what I was never meant to carry alone.

A short prayer

Lord, You are faithful when people are not. Heal the hurt of those who let me down. Teach me to rely on You first, and give me wisdom to find trustworthy people and the courage to lean on them a little. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Help
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication
- Anxiety, Worry, Fear
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Reflect on trusting God, who never fails.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness as you learn to trust again.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being known and cared for.

Truth Be Told
Matthew West & Carly Pearce

Practice honesty about the burdens you carry.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Extreme self-reliance often reflects early disappointment; graded, low-risk experiences of reliability are more helpful than arguing the belief away. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Is there one small thing I could let someone else help with today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Depending on anyone only leads to trouble."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Depending on anyone only leads to trouble." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel you must handle everything alone.

- ☐ Who failed me in the past, and are all people like them?
- ☐ Can I recall someone who was dependable?
- ☐ What does doing everything alone cost me?
- ☐ Could I depend on a person a little, in a small, low-risk way?
- ☐ Is there a difference between wise and foolish dependence?
- ☐ How has God been faithful when people were not?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Some people let me down, but not everyone will.
- ☐ I can depend on others a little at a time and learn who is trustworthy.
- ☐ I can depend on God fully.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise, not weak.
- ☐ I was not meant to carry everything alone.
- ☐ Trust can be built in small steps.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:12
  "And though one may be overpowered, two can resist. Moreover, a cord of three strands is not quickly broken."
- ☐ Proverbs 18:24
  "A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother."
- ☐ Psalm 62:8

"Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge."

☐ Galatians 6:2
"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Ask someone safe for one small, specific favor, and notice what happens.
- ☐ Delegate one small task this week and observe the result.
- ☐ List three people who have kept their word to you.
- ☐ Share a minor difficulty with one trusted person, and record how they responded.
- ☐ Make a small plan with someone and see whether they follow through.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for His faithfulness, then name one person you could trust a little more.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about trusting God and learning to trust again.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Depending on anyone only leads to trouble.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Some people failed me, but not all will. I can depend on God fully and on safe people a little at a time.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Ecclesiastes 4:9–10

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that You never fail me. Help me to lean on You first and to trust wise, safe people in small steps. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

"My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing."

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you keep your feelings to yourself because sharing them seems pointless or like too much of a burden? Do you wonder whether anyone would really want to listen? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward sharing what is inside, and to find the relief that comes from knowing God's word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When feelings were ignored, dismissed, or ridiculed in childhood, a person can learn that they do not matter and that talking about them makes no difference. In some families, feelings simply were not talked about. Over time, silence feels normal and sharing feels pointless.

How the belief can keep itself going

If feelings are never shared, no one has the chance to respond with care, so the person never learns that someone would listen. Unspoken feelings can also fade into numbness, which makes the belief seem true. A single safe experience of being heard can begin to change that.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture invites us to bring our feelings honestly to God. The Psalms are full of complaint, sorrow, and joy poured out before Him. We are also called to carry one another's burdens and to weep and rejoice together, and that cannot happen unless we share. These passages teach that our feelings matter to God and to the people He puts around us.

> *"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ." (Galatians 6:2)*

Also see

> "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep." (Romans 12:15)

> "I pour out my complaint before Him; I reveal my trouble to Him." (Psalm 142:2)

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." (1 Peter 5:7)

> "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail." (James 5:16)

Common self-statements

- No one wants to hear how I feel.
- Talking about it will not help.
- My feelings are not important.
- I would just be a burden.
- It is easier to keep everything inside.
- Why bother saying it? Nothing will change.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will care or understand.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how someone will react without asking.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring times when sharing helped.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that if talking cannot fix it, it is useless.
- Mislabeling: Calling myself a burden instead of a person with needs.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling numb and concluding that I have nothing worth saying.

Challenging questions

- Whose reaction in the past taught me that feelings do not matter?
- Have I ever shared something and felt better afterward?
- What does it cost me to keep everything inside?
- Does talking only matter if it fixes the problem, or can being heard help by itself?
- What would God want to hear from me?
- Who is one safe person I could tell one small feeling?
- If a friend carried what I carry, would I want them to tell me?

Truth summary

My feelings matter to God, and they can matter to the right people. Sharing does not always fix a problem, but being heard can lighten it. I can start small and choose safe people. God invites me to bring everything to Him, and He cares.

A short prayer

Lord, You hear every feeling I pour out. Help me bring them to You, and give me safe people who will listen. Teach me that I am not a burden, and that my heart matters to You. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Communication
- Help
- Friendship
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Anxiety, Worry, Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Truth Be Told
Matthew West & Carly Pearce

Reflect on the freedom of saying what is true.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being fully known and loved.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Bring your feelings just as they are.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness in the hard places.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Limited emotional expression may reflect temperament, learned family patterns, depression, or trauma; helping a person name even one feeling to one safe listener is a workable first step. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "What am I feeling right now, and what could I tell God about it?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you decide not to share how you feel.

- ☐ Whose reaction in the past taught me that feelings do not matter?
- ☐ Have I ever shared something and felt better afterward?
- ☐ What does it cost me to keep everything inside?
- ☐ Does talking only matter if it fixes the problem, or can being heard help by itself?
- ☐ What would God want to hear from me?
- ☐ Who is one safe person I could tell one small feeling?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ My feelings matter to God.
- ☐ Being heard can help even when nothing is fixed.
- ☐ I can start with one small feeling and one safe person.
- ☐ I am not a burden; I am a person with needs.
- ☐ God invites me to bring everything to Him.
- ☐ Some people will care, and I can learn who they are.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Romans 12:15
  "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep."
- ☐ Psalm 142:2
  "I pour out my complaint before Him; I reveal my trouble to Him."

- [ ] 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- [ ] James 5:16
  "Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man has great power to prevail."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Communication. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Write down one feeling each day for a week, even in a few words.
- ☐ Tell God one honest feeling in prayer, using Psalm 142:2 as a guide.
- ☐ Share one small feeling with a trusted person, and note how they responded.
- ☐ Ask a safe person, “Can I tell you something that has been on my mind?”
- ☐ Notice a time this week when you felt something and chose not to say it, and write what you feared.
- ☐ Choose a feelings word list and circle three words that fit your week.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about honesty, being heard, and God's care.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~My feelings aren't worth sharing. Talking about them changes nothing.~~

NEW TRUTH:
My feelings matter to God. Being heard can help, even when nothing is fixed. I can start small with a safe person.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Galatians 6:2

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for caring about what I feel. Help me to bring my heart to You and to share it with safe people, one step at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.

PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #15 · CLOSENESS AND CONNECTION · NOT WORTH THE EFFORT

“Relationships take more than they give, so they aren’t worth the effort.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Do you sometimes feel that relationships take more from you than they give? Do you find yourself weighing what each person costs you? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward healthier, more balanced relationships, and to find the rest that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

Someone who grew up caring for others, or in a home where closeness meant constant demands and little warmth, may learn that people take far more than they give. If the benefits of friendship were rarely experienced, the cost is all that is remembered.

How the belief can keep itself going

If the person invests little, relationships give little, and that seems to prove the belief. Time with draining people is counted, while unseen rewards are missed because they have never been tried. Looking at the whole picture, including what has been lost by staying away, can change the balance.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not hide the cost of love, but it tells us that giving is where blessing is found. Jesus said it is more blessed to give than to receive, and a generous person is refreshed. We are called to encourage one another and not neglect meeting together. These passages do not ignore draining relationships; they point to the fruit of well-chosen, mutual ones.

> *“And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching.” (Hebrews 10:24–25)*

Also see

> “In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: ‘It is more blessed to give than to receive.’” (Acts 20:35)

> “A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed.” (Proverbs 11:25)

> “This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you.” (John 15:12)

> “As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another.” (1 Peter 4:10)

Common self-statements

- People are exhausting.
- I give and give and get nothing back.

- It is not worth the energy.
- I have better things to do than keep up friendships.
- Relationships are more work than they are worth.
- I am better off with fewer demands.

Common logical errors

- Mental filter: Focusing on the costs and overlooking the benefits.
- Overgeneralizing: Concluding that all relationships are draining because some were.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing relationships as either fully rewarding or a waste.
- Discounting the positive: Dismissing good moments as exceptions.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling tired and concluding that people are not worth it.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that new relationships will cost more than they give.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I think relationships cost, and what might they give?
- Which relationships, past or present, have been good for me?
- Have I ever invested in a relationship that was mutual and healthy?
- Is the problem relationships in general, or specific draining ones?
- What has staying away from people cost me?
- What does Scripture say about the blessing of giving and encouraging?
- How could I set limits so that relationships cost less but still give something?

Truth summary

Some relationships are draining, and I am allowed to set limits. But healthy, mutual relationships give comfort, laughter, help, and growth, and I may not have experienced much of that yet. I can choose wisely, give a little, and watch what comes back. God made relationships a source of blessing, not only of cost.

A short prayer

Lord, You know how tiring people have been for me. Heal what has been draining, and teach me healthy limits. Show me one relationship worth investing in, and let me discover the blessing You placed in it. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Love, For Others
- Church
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Love

- Communication
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Reflect on God's goodness reaching you through others.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being known and cared for.

Who You Say I Am
Hillsong Worship

Remember who you are in Christ as you choose who to invest in.

Come As You Are
Crowder

Come as you are; you need not earn your place.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. A cost-benefit view of relationships can reflect real past depletion; exploring what the person has actually received, and teaching limit-setting, avoids dismissing legitimate experiences. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Is there one person who gives me life, and could I spend a few minutes with them today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Relationships take more than they give, so they aren't worth the effort."

✦ ✦ ✦

Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Relationships take more than they give, so they aren't worth the effort." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you think a relationship is not worth the effort.

- ☐ What exactly do I think relationships cost, and what might they give?
- ☐ Which relationships, past or present, have been good for me?
- ☐ Have I ever invested in a relationship that was mutual and healthy?
- ☐ Is the problem relationships in general, or specific draining ones?
- ☐ What has staying away from people cost me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the blessing of giving and encouraging?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Some relationships drain me, and others can renew me.
- ☐ I can set limits and still stay connected.
- ☐ Giving can bring blessing back.
- ☐ I may not have tried enough healthy relationships yet.
- ☐ Good relationships give comfort, laughter, and help.
- ☐ God made us to encourage one another.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Hebrews 10:24–25
  "And let us consider how to spur one another on to love and good deeds. Let us not neglect meeting together, as some have made a habit, but let us encourage one another, and all the more as you see the Day approaching."
- ☐ Acts 20:35
  "In everything, I showed you that by this kind of hard work we must help the weak, remembering the words of the Lord Jesus Himself: 'It is more blessed to give than to receive.'"
- ☐ Proverbs 11:25

"A generous soul will prosper, and he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed."

☐ John 15:12
"This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you."

☐ 1 Peter 4:10
"As good stewards of the manifold grace of God, each of you should use whatever gift he has received to serve one another."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Friendship. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Make two lists about one relationship: what it costs and what it gives. Compare them honestly.
- ☐ Choose one person who has been good to you and spend a short, planned time with them.
- ☐ Do one small kind act for someone and notice how you feel afterward.
- ☐ Set one limit with a draining person, such as ending a call after twenty minutes.
- ☐ Attend one group or gathering for a short, set time, and note what you gained.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for one person who has been a gift, and tell that person thank you.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about what relationships can give, and God's goodness through people.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Relationships take more than they give, so they aren't worth the effort.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Some relationships drain me, but healthy ones give far more than they take. I can set limits and still be connected.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Hebrews 10:24–25

A short prayer

Lord, thank You for the people who have blessed me. Help me to set healthy limits, to give wisely, and to receive the good You send through others. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.